LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

How to Make Friends as an Adult

How many hours it takes to turn a stranger into a friend, why people probably like you more than you think, natural English for inviting people and keeping in touch – and "the waving man".



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · After you listen 💬
Solve the crossword, write a specific invitation – and send that message to an old friend!

0 Warm-up: My friendship check

fun · no points

Be honest! Tick everything that is true for you. 😊

- ☐ 🏙️ I've moved to a new city
- ☐ 📵 I've lost touch with a friend
- ☐ ⚽ I go to a weekly class or club
- ☐ ☕ I'm a regular somewhere
- ☐ ⏳ I wait for others to invite me
- ☐ 👋 I've waved at the wrong person!

My friendship score: _____ / 6

Guess! How many hours together does it take to turn an acquaintance into a casual friend?

(a) about 5 hours (b) about 50 hours (c) about 500 hours

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 2:58**

Jack: "I waved back with my whole arm..." 🙈



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – or write them in your notebook.

1. How did you meet your best friend?

2. Is it harder to make friends as an adult? Why?

3. Who is a friend you'd love to hear from again?

4. Where could you meet new people in your town?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Then check at ⏱️ 13:10 and ⏱️ 14:08

- ☐ **1.** an acquaintance
- ☐ **2.** to hit it off
- ☐ **3.** to drift apart
- ☐ **4.** to keep in touch
- ☐ **5.** to break the ice
- ☐ **6.** to belong
- ☐ **7.** lonely
- ☐ **8.** a regular
- ☐ **9.** to swap
- ☐ **10.** the liking gap

a) to continue to contact someone – messages, calls, visits
b) someone who goes to the same café or shop again and again
c) someone you know a little, but not well
d) to exchange: give one thing and get another
e) to slowly become less close, usually without an argument
f) sad because you don't have friends or people around you
g) to like each other and get on well very quickly
h) people like us more than we think they do
i) to feel happy and comfortable in a place or group
j) to make people feel relaxed at the start of a meeting



Pronunciation corner 🔊 ac-**QUAIN**-tance (/əˈkweɪntəns/ – stress in the middle!) · be-**LONG** · **LONE**-ly · **REG**-u-lar · friend (/frend/ – the **i** is silent!). Say it: *"We hit it off straight away!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) Adults can't really make new friends – real friendships only start at school.
- (b) Friendship takes time and a little courage – people probably like you more than you think, so be the one who asks.
- (c) One great conversation is all you need to become best friends.



Jack's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

crayons · football boots · food bank · bridge · soup · emoji · cinema · bakery

3 Know it or hear it? quiz + listening 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. "Last year, I made _____ with my neighbour."

(a) a friendship
(b) friends
(c) friend

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

2. "I don't have any friends here. I feel a bit _____."

(a) alone
(b) only
(c) lonely

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

3. "Do you _____ a cup of tea?" (= would you like)

(a) fancy
(b) like to
(c) want of

🧠 Everyday British English

4. "We _____ touch when she moved abroad."

(a) broke
(b) lost
(c) missed

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

5. "Count me in!" means…

(a) Count my money.
(b) I don't want to come.
(c) Include me – I want to come!

🧠 Everyday English

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. Who was the man on the other side of the road waving at?

(a) Jack
(b) a bus driver
(c) his friend, behind Jack

🎧 ⏱️ 0:05

7. In Hall's first study, people had moved to a new place in the last…

(a) six months
(b) six weeks
(c) six years

🎧 ⏱️ 2:58

8. In the liking gap study, strangers first talked for…

(a) an hour
(b) five minutes
(c) a whole day

🎧 ⏱️ 5:18

9. How many studies did Holt-Lunstad's team look at?

(a) 48
(b) 148
(c) 1,048

🎧 ⏱️ 7:45

10. What did Tom shout when he saw Jack at football?

(a) "It's the waving man!"
(b) "Welcome to the team!"
(c) "Nice to see you again!"

🎧 ⏱️ 20:05

👋 **Fun fact:** Every year, on the day they met, Tom sends Jack the same message: just a waving hand emoji!

4 True or false? listening 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	Jack started crossing the road, still waving and smiling.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	Tom was angry when he met Jack in the middle of the road.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
3	Time spent working together counted as much as time spent having fun.	T	F	⏱️ 2:58
4	Most people thought their partner liked them *more* than they really did.	T	F	⏱️ 5:18
5	Shyer people tended to have a bigger liking gap.	T	F	⏱️ 5:18
6	The 2010 review proves that friends make you live longer.	T	F	⏱️ 7:45

5 Three friendship studies 🔍 listening 6 points



Which study is each sentence about? Write **A**, **B** or **C**. ⏱️ 2:58 · 5:18 · 7:45

A · Hours to a friend ⏱️
2018 · Jeffrey Hall, University of Kansas

B · The liking gap 💭
2018 · Erica Boothby, Gus Cooney and team

C · Friends and health ❤️
2010 · Julianne Holt-Lunstad, Brigham Young Univ.

1	It looked at 148 studies with more than 300,000 people.	☐
2	More than 350 adults who had just moved were trying to make new friends.	☐
3	Strangers had a short conversation and then answered two questions.	☐
4	It took more than 200 hours to become close friends.	☐
5	Students sharing accommodation kept underestimating for months.	☐
6	Stronger relationships were linked to about a 50% higher chance of surviving.	☐

6 The friendship ladder new! hours and maths 6 points



A. Listen at ⏱️ 2:58 and write the hours on each step (1 point each). **B.** Do the maths (1 point each).

🤗 **close friend**
more than _____ hours

😄 **friend**
around _____ hours

😊 **casual friend**
about _____ hours

🙂 **acquaintance**
you know them a little

🗓️ You see someone for **two hours every weekend**. How many weeks until you reach…

4. 50 hours? _____ weeks · 5. 90 hours? _____ weeks · 6. 200 hours? _____ weeks (about two years!)

7 "Do you fancy joining us?" listening 10 points



Two colleagues have been chatting at work for a few weeks. Finally, Jack invites Lucy to something. Listen at ⏱ 12:01 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱ 13:10 can help.



LUCY
Morning, Jack. Good 1 _____?



JACK
Yeah, not bad, thanks. Actually, I wanted to ask you something. A few of us from the office go for a walk along the 2 _____ every Saturday morning, with our families. Then we usually have breakfast together. Do you 3 _____ joining us this week?



LUCY
Oh, that sounds lovely. I'd 4 _____ to. What time do you usually meet?



JACK
About nine, by the old bridge. It's very relaxed. Just walking and chatting.



LUCY
5 _____ me in. I've been 6 _____ to explore that part of town since I moved here.



JACK
Great. Let's 7 _____ numbers, and I'll send you the details.



LUCY
Perfect. To be honest, I was worried you'd think I was a bit boring. I've been so quiet since I started.



JACK
Not at all! Everyone in the team likes you. We just didn't want to 8 _____ you.



LUCY
That's funny. I thought the same about you.



JACK
Well, now we know. See you on Saturday, then.



LUCY
See you there. I'll bring some fresh bread from the bakery.

A. They meet at nine, by the old _____.

B. Lucy will bring fresh _____.

8 Phrases to steal expressions 4 points

Match each phrase from the chat (1–4) to its meaning (a–d). ⏱ 13:10

- ☐ **1.** "Good weekend?"
- ☐ **2.** "I'd love to."
- ☐ **3.** "I've been meaning to…"
- ☐ **4.** "Let's swap numbers."

a) I've wanted to do it for a while, but I haven't yet.
b) Let's give each other our phone numbers.
c) Did you have a good weekend?
d) Yes, please! (a warm way to accept)

9 Friendship idioms

idioms · 6 points



Complete each sentence with a word from the box. ⏱️ 14:08

fair-weather | ice | indeed | off | pod | way

1. 🍲 Tom brought soup when Jack was ill. A friend in need is a friend _____!
2. ☀️ She only calls when life is fun. She's a _____ friend.
3. 👧 Sarah and I met when we were six. We go back a long _____.
4. 🫛 They even laugh the same way – they're like two peas in a _____.
5. 😂 He told a funny story to break the _____.
6. 🗣️ We hit it _____ straight away – we talked for three hours!



Jack's tip: "Hit it off" doesn't mean hitting anyone – don't worry! 😄 And a boat **drifts** when it moves slowly with the water, with nobody steering it – that's how friends **drift apart**. 🛶

10 Yes, no or another time?

new! replying to invitations · 6 points



Someone invites you to something. Is each reply **A** (accept), **D** (decline politely) or **S** (suggest another time)?

✅ A = accept | 🙏 D = decline politely | 📅 S = suggest another time

1. "Count me in!" ☐

2. "I'd love to, but I'm working on Saturday." ☐

3. "How about next Friday instead?" ☐

4. "Sounds great – what time?" ☐

5. "I'm afraid I can't this week. Thanks for asking!" ☐

6. "What about a coffee on Sunday?" ☐



Lucy's tip: A polite "no" = **show interest** + **but** + **a reason**: *"Oh, I'd love to, but I'm visiting my mum."* Add another time and the door stays open: *"How about next week?"* 🚪

📅 **Invite like a pro!** (no points) "We should meet up sometime" = never. A good invitation has three parts. ⏱️ 9:30

🚶 WHAT	🗓️ WHEN	📍 WHERE
a walk, a coffee, a class…	Saturday morning, after work…	the park, the old bridge…

"I'm going to _____ on _____ at _____. Would you like to come?"

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱️ 17:19

😐 1. "I made a friendship with my neighbour." 😊 _____

😐 2. "I am alone in this city." (you feel sad) 😊 _____

😐 3. "Do you want to go out with me?" (to a new friend) 😊 _____

😐 4. "Let's meet one day." 😊 _____

😐 5. "I'm missing you, my friend." 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: Careful! **"Go out with someone"** can sound like a date. 💘 For friends, say *"Do you want to hang out?"* And *"He's a close friend **of mine**"* sounds more natural than *"He is my close friend."*

😔 Alone or lonely?

tick · no points



Alone = without other people (it can be happy!). **Lonely** = sad because you don't have friends around you. ⏱️ 17:19

1. I love being _____ on Sunday mornings. It's so peaceful. ☕	☐ 😔 alone	☐ 😢 lonely
2. After she moved, she felt _____ for months. 🏙️	☐ 😔 alone	☐ 😢 lonely
3. Jack walked home _____ – and he enjoyed the quiet. 🌙	☐ 😔 alone	☐ 😢 lonely
4. Without his friends, he felt really _____. 😔	☐ 😔 alone	☐ 😢 lonely
5. You can be _____ in a room full of people. 🎉	☐ 😔 alone	☐ 😢 lonely
6. I sometimes have lunch _____ – it's relaxing. 🥪	☐ 😔 alone	☐ 😢 lonely

💭 **Mind the liking gap!** (no points) After a conversation, our worries are usually wrong. Rewrite each worry as a kinder, more realistic thought. ⏱️ 5:18

😟 "They probably think I'm boring." 💜 *"They probably liked me more than I think."*

😟 "I talked too much. They hated it." _____

😟 "They won't want to meet up with me." _____

🗓️ Where will your 50 hours come from?

plan · no points



Jack's tip: do something regularly, with the same people – then the hours add up by themselves! Circle one idea, then complete the sentence. ⏱️ 9:30

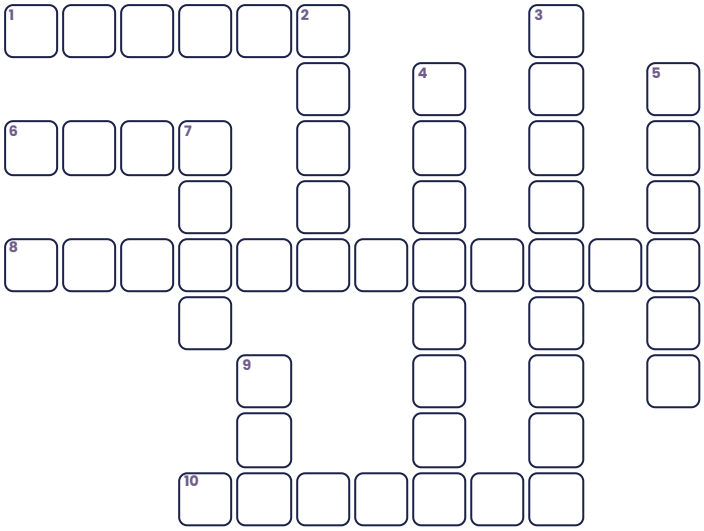
🎨 a weekly class · ⚽ a sports team · 🚶 a walking group · 🥫 volunteering · 📚 a book club · ☕ being a regular

"Every _____, I'm going to _____."

12 Friendship crossword 🧩 puzzle 10 points



Read the clues and write the words in the grid (1 point each). The number in brackets is the number of letters. Letters that cross help you!



➡️ Across

1 The Saturday walk starts at nine, by the old ___. (6)

6 Two very similar people are like two ___ in a pod. (4)

8 Someone you know a little, but not well: an ___. (12)

10 Someone who goes to the same café again and again: a ___. (7)

⬇️ Down

2 Every year, Tom sends Jack a waving hand ___. (5)

3 To help at a food bank or a charity event for free: to ___. (9)

4 Jack met Tom again at five-a-side ___ on a Wednesday evening. (8)

5 Sad because you don't have friends around you: ___. (6)

7 When Jack was ill, Tom brought him ___ and medicine. (4)

9 Say something to help people relax: break the ___. (3)

13 The waving man ⚽ listening 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 0:05 and ⏱️ 20:05. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

☐ ⚽ Two weeks later, Jack joined a five-a-side football team.

☐ 👋 Jack waved back at a man on the other side of the road.

☐ 🍲 When Jack was ill, Tom brought him soup and medicine.

☐ 📣 Tom shouted, "It's the waving man!" – and everyone laughed.

☐ 🛣️ They met in the middle of the road: "Well, I'm Tom."

☐ 🍽️ After football, they started eating together – then dinners and Sunday walks.

Think about it 💭 (no points) Why was "the waving man" story actually the best thing that could happen to Jack?

14 Your turn

writing · 8 points

2 points for each good sentence.



A. How I met my best friend 🤝

Use **hit it off**, **go back a long way** or **keep in touch**. *e.g. "We met at a dance class and hit it off straight away."*

B. My specific invitation 📅

"Sometime" means never! Invite someone with an activity, a day and a place. *e.g. "I'm going for a walk in the park on Saturday morning. Would you like to come?"*



⏱️ My friendship week

your 7-day mission

One small, brave step every day. Remember: they probably like you more than you think!

Day	Small step	What happened?	Done?
1	💬 **message an old friend**		☐
2	👋 **say hello to a neighbour**		☐
3	☕ **be a regular somewhere**		☐
4	⚽ **find a weekly group**		☐
5	📅 **invite someone**		☐
6	✅ **say yes to an invitation**		☐
7	🎙️ **send a voice note**		☐

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

👋 MEET
Nice to meet you!
Good weekend?
Let's swap numbers.

📅 INVITE
Do you fancy…?
Are you free on Saturday?
Would you like to come?

✅ REPLY
I'd love to!
Count me in.
I'd love to, but…

💌 KEEP IN TOUCH
I was thinking about you.
Let's keep in touch!
I've missed you!

Can you do it now?

I can…	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain how many hours it takes to make a friend.	😟	🙂	😄
explain the liking gap – and why it's good news.	😟	🙂	😄
invite someone, and accept or decline politely.	😟	🙂	😄
use alone / lonely and "hang out" instead of "go out with".	😟	🙂	😄



Share it with us! Tell us in the comments how you met your best friend. Did you **hit it off** straight away? Do you **go back a long way**? And have you ever waved at someone who wasn't waving at you? 👋😅

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: b – about 50 hours. · Predict: **cinema** 🎬 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 c · 2 g · 3 e · 4 a · 5 j · 6 i · 7 f · 8 b · 9 d · 10 h
Big idea: b (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 b · 2 c · 3 a · 4 b · 5 c · 6 c · 7 a · 8 b · 9 b · 10 a

4 · True or false?

1 T · 2 F (he laughed: "Nice to meet you anyway") · 3 F (time having fun counted more) · 4 F (they thought they were liked *less*) · 5 T · 6 F (it's a link, not proof)

5 · Three studies · 6 · The friendship ladder

5: 1 C · 2 A · 3 B · 4 A · 5 B · 6 C
6: casual friend about 50 · friend around 90 · close friend more than 200 · 4 25 weeks · 5 45 weeks · 6 100 weeks

7 · "Do you fancy joining us?"

1 weekend · 2 river · 3 fancy · 4 love · 5 Count · 6 meaning · 7 swap · 8 bother · A bridge · B bread

8 · Phrases to steal

1 c · 2 d · 3 a · 4 b

9 · Idioms · 10 · Yes, no or another time?

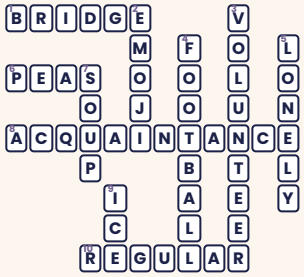
9: 1 indeed · 2 fair-weather · 3 way · 4 pod · 5 ice · 6 off
10: 1 A · 2 D · 3 S · 4 A · 5 D · 6 S

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 I made friends with my neighbour. / My neighbour and I became friends. · 2 I feel a bit lonely in this city. · 3 Do you want to hang out this weekend? / Would you like to meet up on Saturday? · 4 We should meet up sometime. / Are you free on Saturday morning? · 5 I miss you! / I've missed you!
Alone or lonely? 1 alone · 2 lonely · 3 alone · 4 lonely · 5 lonely · 6 alone

12 · Crossword

Across: 1 bridge · 6 peas · 8 acquaintance · 10 regular
Down: 2 emoji · 3 volunteer · 4 football · 5 lonely · 7 soup · 9 ice



13 · The waving man · 14 · Your turn

1 👋 waved back · 2 🛣️ "Well, I'm Tom." · 3 ⚽ joined football · 4 📣 "It's the waving man!" · 5 🍽️ eating together, dinners, walks · 6 🍲 soup and medicine
Think about it: it broke the ice – everyone laughed, and he wasn't the new guy anymore.
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

Your score

90–100 🏆 **A friend indeed!** · 70–89 🤝 **You hit it off** · 50–69 🧊 **Breaking the ice** · 0–49 👋 **Waving at the wrong person – listen again!**

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